

Neck & Shoulder Pain Tracker

A 30-day record of where it hurts, what set it off, and what actually helped — so your next appointment starts with facts instead of guesswork.

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How to use this journal

Five minutes a day is enough. Consistency beats detail — a half-filled page every day is worth more than a perfect page once a week.

THE ROUTINE

- ☐ Fill the daily log at the same time each evening
- ☐ Mark the body map whenever the location changes
- ☐ Note the trigger while you still remember it
- ☐ Shade the 30-day grid before bed — ten seconds
- ☐ Do the weekly review every Sunday
- ☐ Bring the doctor prep page to your appointment

Rate pain on the same 0–10 scale every time. The absolute number matters far less than the direction it moves over weeks.

THE SCALE YOU WILL USE

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

NO PAIN WORST IMAGINABLE

WHAT THE NUMBERS MEAN

- 1 Noticeable, easy to ignore 3 Annoying, does not stop you 5 Hard to concentrate through 7 Limits what you can do
- 9 Unable to function

Print the daily log thirty times and the rest once. That is the whole system.

This is a record-keeping tool, not medical advice. Bring it to a professional rather than using it to self-diagnose.

WHAT I WANT TO GET OUT OF THIS

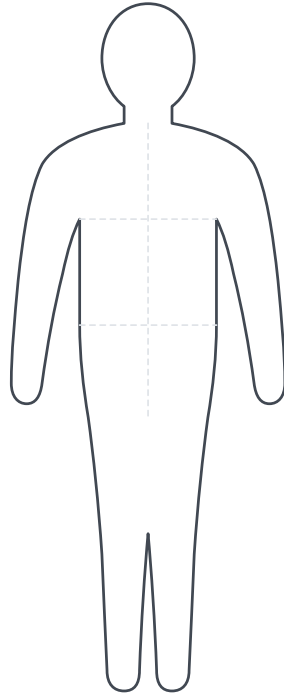
BASELINE

Where it hurts

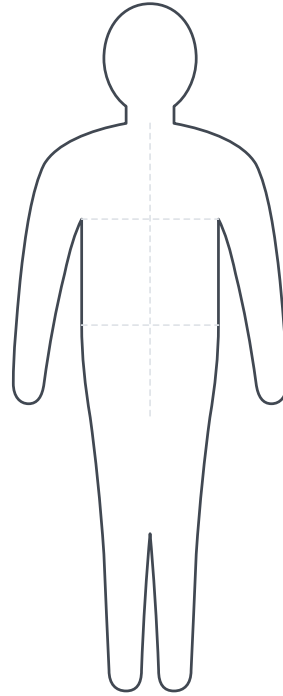
Do this on day one, then again every two weeks. Comparing two maps a month apart is often the clearest evidence you have.

DATE

OVERALL LEVEL TODAY (0–10)



FRONT



BACK

MARKING KEY write the letter on the spot that hurts

A Aching / dull **S** Sharp / stabbing **B** Burning **T** Tingling / numb **R** Radiating (draw an arrow) **St** Stiff / restricted

DESCRIBE IT IN YOUR OWN WORDS

DAILY

Daily log

Print one per day.

DATE	HOURS SLEPT	WOKE UP RESTED?	WEATHER

PAIN ON WAKING

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
NONE										WORST

PAIN AT BEDTIME

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
NONE										WORST

THROUGH THE DAY

TIME	WHAT I WAS DOING	0-10	NOTE

SYMPTOMS TODAY

☐ Stiffness on waking	☐ Pain turning head left	☐ Pain turning head right
☐ Headache from base of skull	☐ Shoulder blade ache	☐ Tingling in arm or hand
☐ Jaw or temple tension	☐ Clicking or grinding	☐ Dizziness

ANYTHING ELSE

Trigger tracker

Tick what you did, then rate the pain that followed. Four weeks of this usually names the culprit.

SUSPECTED TRIGGERS

DATE	TRIGGER	HOW LONG	PAIN AFTER (0-10)	CERTAIN?

USUAL SUSPECTS TO WATCH

- ☐ Desk / laptop session
- ☐ Driving
- ☐ Phone or tablet use
- ☐ Sleep position
- ☐ Stress or deadline
- ☐ Carrying a bag on one side
- ☐ Workout or lifting
- ☐ Cold or draught
- ☐ Long day standing

30-day pain grid

MONTH YEAR

YEAR

— 0-2 · good day / 3-4 · manageable X 5-6 · difficult # 7-10 · flare

[illegible]

Relief log

The point of this page is to stop repeating things that never worked.

TRIED AND RATED

DATE	WHAT I TRIED	HOW LONG	PAIN BEFORE	PAIN AFTER	AGAIN?

THINGS WORTH TESTING

- ☐ Heat pack, 15 min
- ☐ Doorway chest stretch
- ☐ Different pillow
- ☐ Ice, 10 min
- ☐ Walk, 20 min
- ☐ Massage
- ☐ Chin tucks
- ☐ Screen at eye level
- ☐ Prescribed exercises

TREATMENT

Medication & treatment log

Keep one honest record. Doctors ask this question and almost nobody can answer it accurately.

MEDICATION

DATE	WHAT	DOSE	TIME	DID IT HELP?

APPOINTMENTS & THERAPY

DATE	WHO I SAW	WHAT WAS DONE	COST

EVERY SUNDAY

Weekly review

Ten minutes looking back is where the pattern actually shows up.

WEEK OF

BEST DAY

WORST DAY

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

DAY	AVG PAIN	SLEEP	NOTABLE

WHAT MADE IT BETTER

WHAT MADE IT WORSE

ONE THING TO CHANGE NEXT WEEK

APPOINTMENT

Doctor visit prep

Fill this in the day before. Most appointments are short — walking in with this changes what you get out of it.

DATE OF VISIT	SEEING

IN ONE SENTENCE, WHAT IS THE PROBLEM?

THE FACTS

QUESTION	YOUR ANSWER

HAVE YOU ALREADY TRIED

☐ Rest	☐ Heat	☐ Ice
☐ Stretching	☐ Painkillers	☐ Physio
☐ Massage	☐ New pillow	☐ Desk changes

QUESTIONS I WANT ANSWERED

WHAT WAS DECIDED

FREE SPACE

Notes

Anything the structured pages did not capture.

Before you start

These pages are a personal record-keeping tool. They are not a medical device, they do not diagnose anything, and nothing here is medical advice.

Tracking is useful because it turns vague memory into specifics you can hand to a professional: when it started, what makes it worse, what you already tried. It is not a substitute for seeing one.

See a qualified healthcare professional about any new, severe, or worsening symptom. Seek urgent care for chest pain, numbness or weakness in a limb, loss of bladder or bowel control, severe headache of sudden onset, pain following an accident, fever with neck stiffness, or any symptom that frightens you.

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